



The band Eisley is perhaps the first true "MySpace Sensation", a band that came from the anonymity of the Internet and went on to the fame of the billboard charts

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to these young schoolgirls, at a film school in Mumbai. The teams were then assigned volunteers, who helped in the process of film making, from the shooting to the editing. The schoolgirls however, planned out the movie, came up with the concepts and the story. Issues picked up included trafficking and dowry. The idea of empowering the suffering sections of the society to create short films



The She Creates Project

based on the issues that affect them most worked well, and the resulting films were straight from the heart without any interference in between. The movies were screened to a large audience, with more celebrities showing up than there were schoolgirls.

The latest project from Mam movies is an ingenious combination of film making and social networking. The Metta Media project is an open source gift economy for films. Film makers are encouraged to collaborate, create and post films on the Metta Media project web site. The Metta Media project web site is actively involved in bringing about changes in society. NGOs and other social cause platforms can post a requirement for a movie project on the web site. Filmmakers can choose the projects they want to work on, and get help from Metta Studios, which loans out equipment for use in the film making process. Unlike the previous projects, there is no fund raiser here, and the participants have to "serve with what they have". The project web site is at mettamedia.ning.com for those who are interested in participating.



Sridharan Ravichandran

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Chennai based artist Sridharan Ravichandran released a self produced Album called Transcend on line. Transcend is an instrumental rock album, with a distinctively Indian feel on all the nine tracks. The album is hosted on sridharsmusic.com, and visitors have a bunch of options when it comes to picking up the album. The album was initially released as a paid CD. The tracks are now free to download, but users can choose to buy the album, or simply donate if they feel like it. For artists like Sridharan, the Internet is a great tool as it circumvents music labels, and allows a direct interface between the artists and the listener. "The internet is amazing - it has opened up networks, doors, and opportunities for musicians everywhere. When Transcend was still a paid CD,

I was able to leverage social media to reach ears as far out as Greece, Thailand, etc.", says Sridharan when asked how the Internet helped the album. When asked why he chooses to give away music for free, Sridharan says "I was definitely more focussed on reaching as many ears as possible, rather than for any other monetary aspect. While reward for effort is important, there are a lot of other things one can do to



The Transcend Album

make money from their music rather than just from CD sales. The internet has played a major role in making this happen too." The internet can go

a long way in allowing artists to get their music to ears across the world.

Sean Fournier

Sean Fournier released an album called "Oh My" on a number of web sites online, including a homepage, sean-fournier.com. The release is one of the most popular albums on the free album site, Jamendo. The Album was conceptualised as a free album from the very beginning. The very idea of releasing an Album for free opened up new audiences, and removed a number



Sean Fournier's album, Oh My

of hurdles. "The idea behind 'Oh My' was simple: Make a free album that people would share. The main goal was to expand my fan base the quickest way possible.

Without the hurdle of a price tag, I was hoping people would see the album and think, 'Why not? It's free. I'll listen'. Since the release of my free album, my mailing list has grown over 13 times its size. I love giving my music away. It's actually really fun. I don't like coming off as a selly business person. At the end of the day I just want people to listen. Releasing the album for free lifted the burden of trying to sell something and it actually increased my sales anyway." There are a number of sites online that allow artists to host free music content. Sean's music is hosted on Pandora, Last.fm, MySpace, and Jamendo amongst others. We asked Sean which was the best music hosting web site in his experience, "My favorite platform is by far Jamendo. The community actually writes reviews and I feel a great sense of support from that site." **d**